OSHA 1910.27 Scaffold and Rope Descent System Checklist

Use at the start of each workshift a rope descent system will be used, and when checking a general industry scaffold.

OSHA 29 CFR 1910.27

DATE	SHIFT
INSPECTOR	AREA / EQUIPMENT ID

Before you start

1. Mark every item OK, Defect or N/A.
2. If an item fails, do not start or continue the descent or scaffold work until it is corrected; take damaged or defective equipment out of service and replace it.
3. The manufacturer's instructions and site rules may add checks to this list.

Legal basis: 29 CFR 1910.27: Scaffolds and rope descent systems (Part 1910 Subpart D: Walking-Working Surfaces) Source: eCFR, Title 29, text as of 2026-11-09

Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1910-27-scaffolds-rope-descent-systems

SECTION A | Scaffolds and anchorage records

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
1	Scaffold compliance Ref. 1910.27(a)	Any scaffold in use has been checked against subpart L (Scaffolds) of 29 CFR part 1926.	☐	☐	☐	
2	Building owner's written anchorage information Ref. 1910.27(b)(1)(i)	Written statement from the building owner that each anchorage is identified, tested, certified and maintained to support at least 5,000 pounds (2,268 kg) in any direction for each employee attached.	☐	☐	☐	
3	Annual anchorage inspection Ref. 1910.27(b)(1)(i)	The owner's information is based on an annual inspection by a qualified person.	☐	☐	☐	
4	Anchorage certification Ref. 1910.27(b)(1)(i)	Each anchorage has been certified by a qualified person as necessary and within the last 10 years.	☐	☐	☐	
5	Information obtained before use Ref. 1910.27(b)(1)(ii)	The employer had the written anchorage information before any employee used an anchorage.	☐	☐	☐	
6	Information kept for the job Ref. 1910.27(b)(1)(ii)	The anchorage information is retained and available for the whole duration of the job.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION B | Conditions before descent

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
7	Height above grade Ref. 1910.27(b)(2)(i)	Work is not above 300 feet (91 m) above grade, or the employer has demonstrated other means are not feasible or pose a greater hazard.	☐	☐	☐	
8	Stabilization on long descents Ref. 1910.27(b)(2)(x)	Where the descent is greater than 130 feet (39.6 m), stabilization is in place at the specific work location.	☐	☐	☐	

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

SECTION B | Conditions before descent

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
9	Weather Ref. 1910.27(b)(2)(xi)	No storms, gusty or excessive wind or other hazardous weather at the time of use.	☐	☐	☐	
10	User training Ref. 1910.27(b)(2)(iii)	Every employee using the system has been trained in accordance with § 1910.30.	☐	☐	☐	
11	Shift inspection Ref. 1910.27(b)(2)(iv)	The system was inspected at the start of this workshift.	☐	☐	☐	
12	Manufacturer limits Ref. 1910.27(b)(2)(ii)	Use matches the manufacturer's instructions, warnings and design limitations, or is directed by a qualified person.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION C | Equipment, rigging and ropes

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
13	Damaged equipment Ref. 1910.27(b)(2)(iv)	No damaged or defective component in use; any found has been removed from service and replaced.	☐	☐	☐	
14	Component rating Ref. 1910.27(b)(2)(vii)	Every component other than the seat board is rated to sustain a minimum load of 5,000 pounds (22.2 kN).	☐	☐	☐	
15	Seat board Ref. 1910.27(b)(2)(vii)	Seat board is capable of supporting a live load of 300 pounds (136 kg).	☐	☐	☐	
16	Rigging and tiebacks Ref. 1910.27(b)(2)(v)	Anchorages and tiebacks rigged properly; tiebacks fitted wherever counterweights, cornice hooks or similar non-permanent anchorages are used.	☐	☐	☐	
17	Rope edge protection Ref. 1910.27(b)(2)(ix)	Padding or other protection on ropes at every point they can touch building edges, the anchorage, obstructions or other surfaces.	☐	☐	☐	
18	Destructive conditions Ref. 1910.27(b)(2)(xiii)	Ropes kept away from open flames, hot work, corrosive chemicals and other destructive conditions.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION D | Fall arrest, rescue and dropped objects

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
19	Independent fall arrest Ref. 1910.27(b)(2)(vi)	Each employee is connected to a separate, independent personal fall arrest system meeting subpart I of part 1910.	☐	☐	☐	
20	Rescue Ref. 1910.27(b)(2)(viii)	Arrangements are in place to rescue each employee promptly after a fall.	☐	☐	☐	
21	Tools and buckets Ref. 1910.27(b)(2)(xii)	Tools, squeegees, buckets and similar equipment are secured by tool lanyards or a similar method.	☐	☐	☐	

DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

Item no.	Defect description	Reported to	Action taken / date closed

SIGN-OFF

SAFE TO OPERATE?	☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service	
INSPECTOR SIGNATURE		DATE / TIME
SUPERVISOR REVIEW		DATE / TIME

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